

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner for compliance-driven enterprise software.*

Positioning, 13 years owning regulated-industry backlogs, translating complex workflow requirements into shipped software across healthcare, insurance, public sector, and defence.

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§ WHY SPHERA

Sphera builds EHS and chemical management software that real compliance teams depend on, not a pilot, but a workflow teams cannot skip. That kind of product puts heavy pressure on the Product Owner to get requirements right before a line of code is written, because the cost of a misunderstood regulation showing up in production is high. The role explicitly calls for someone who can bridge Product Management, Regulatory, Professional Services, and Engineering, exactly the four-way alignment I ran at the Federal Employment Agency and at EMIL Group. *That combination of regulated-domain pressure and cross-functional brokering is where my experience is most directly useful.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case drafting
- **GitHub Copilot**, code review and requirement validation
- **Cursor**, codebase-level refactoring and exploration
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, research, analysis, and documentation support
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-ready presentations

- **Miro**, workshop facilitation and backlog mapping
 - **n8n**, agentic workflow design and automation
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT SPHERA

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Read the Chemical Management backlog end to end, shadow a Regulatory or Professional Services call, and map the current requirements process, where stories go thin, where acceptance criteria are missing, and where Engineering and Regulatory are working from different assumptions.

WEEK 2

Tighten the top.

Work with the Product Manager and Engineering to sharpen the top 20% of the backlog: rewrite stories that lack clear acceptance criteria, flag any that depend on architectural decisions not yet made, and confirm which items block active customer commitments.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Take the first refined stories through planning, attend daily standups to clear blockers early, run acceptance reviews on delivered functionality, and start feeding back what I learn from PS and Regulatory into the roadmap process.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Sphera team,

Chemical management software sits in a regulated space where a missing field or a misunderstood compliance rule is not a UX inconvenience, it is a customer risk. I have spent 13 years as a Product Owner and Product Manager in environments where that pressure was constant: healthcare workflows at CLINET Platforms, labour-market data for German federal policymakers, defence AI for the FCAS programme, and insurance B2B SaaS at EMIL Group. In each case my core job was the same as the one Sphera is describing, translate what Regulatory, Professional Services, and end users actually need into requirements Engineering can act on.

The Sphera posting specifically calls out product re-architecture and modernisation. At the Federal Employment Agency I led a full migration from a bare-metal system to containers while simultaneously running a large ETL migration and a UI relaunch, three threads that touched every team, all running in the same period. At Rohde & Schwarz I shifted the platform strategy from UI-led to developer-code-first after workflow instrumentation showed the UI approach was generating zero adoption. Both cases required keeping stakeholders with very different incentives aligned on a single backlog priority while the architecture underneath them changed.

On the requirements side: I write user stories and acceptance criteria as working contracts, not summaries. At CLINET Platforms I cut a backlog to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures, and user acceptance rose more than fivefold. At Scheidt & Bachmann I moved research outputs into production across a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning. I am comfortable in both fast-moving Scrum teams and larger scaled-agile environments.

I have also been building with AI tools for the past two years, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, and others, to accelerate research, analysis, and documentation. For a role that lists AI tooling as a nice-to-have, I can bring that into requirements drafting and edge-case generation from day one.

I would be glad to walk through any of these projects in more detail.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product Owner and Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries, public-sector analytics, defence AI, insurance, healthcare, and payments. I manage backlogs, write user stories and acceptance criteria, run cross-functional discovery with

Regulatory and Professional Services stakeholders, and lead agile teams from requirements through acceptance. Experienced in enterprise B2B software, SAFe and Scrum delivery, and software modernisation programmes.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Spearheaded development of the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS programme, managing a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.
- Championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT, NUREMBERG / REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Carried a full migration from bare-metal to containers, a large ETL migration, and a UI relaunch through the same period while keeping the team in autonomous control of its environments.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut the backlog to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital information system workflows: digital anamnesis time dropped from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

- Retail and payments, POS and forecourt systems. Moved research results into production in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 - 06/2021

- Government, secure data platform. Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019 - 05/2020

- Health insurance, B2B procurement webshop. Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG | 04/2019 - 12/2019

- Wind energy, full site IT modernisation end to end.

PRODUCT OWNER, WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN, ISNY | 08/2017 - 06/2018

- Healthcare, clinical network. Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - PRESENT

- Construction staffing B2B marketplace. Zero to one alone: LLM agents across the funnel, anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface. Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption hardware and software. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO, SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES, BERLIN | 03/2018 - 08/2021

- Nanotechnology and agriculture. Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds, owning financial planning and investor reporting.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 - 11/2018

- Fintech, mobile P2P payments. Built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ SKILLS

Product Ownership: user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, sprint review, retrospective, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT (user acceptance testing), Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI planning, SDLC (software development lifecycle).

Regulated and Compliance Domains: B2B SaaS, public sector, defence, healthcare, health insurance, fintech, identity management, GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, EU AI Act, AI governance.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, GPT, Gamma.app.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitOps, REST APIs, Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, Azure DevOps.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · SPHERA

